

# Mike Schafer

Phone: 410-698-7206

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## Professional Summary

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I'm an experienced IT Specialist and Technology Consultant with over 20 years of hands-on experience in troubleshooting, system administration, hardware/software support, network security, and IT infrastructure management. Throughout my career, I've successfully tackled complex technical issues in residential, commercial, healthcare, and government sectors. I'm skilled in security protocols, malware protection, cloud storage, data migration, and IoT integration, and have a strong ability to optimize IT systems, configure networks (wired and wireless), and ensure robust data security. I take pride in my ability to clearly communicate technical concepts to both technical and non-technical stakeholders, and have a proven track record of leading teams, managing IT projects, and collaborating with vendors. I'm passionate about continuous learning and always strive to maintain efficiency and deliver high-quality results.

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## Work Experience

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### **PC Technologies - 11/2002-Present** **IT Specialist / Technology Consultant**

- Remediate security issues with customer accounts and systems including breaches, compromised/hacked accounts, phishing, scams, intrusion, etc.
- Implementation, maintenance and support of malware protection, cloud storage, cloud backup, local imaging and backups and testing of these implementations in real world scenarios
- Education and implementation on secure protocols, 2FA, authentication methods, authentication apps, wireless security, general computer security, internet security, social media security and privacy, etc.
- On-site and remote troubleshooting and repair of various computer, peripherals, AV systems, server and network issues
- Installation and upgrading of software and operating systems
- Installation, maintenance and support of wired and wireless networks including managed switches and firewalls
- Support and remediation of hacked accounts and systems
- Cloud based server configuration, system administration and data migration
- Design, build and testing of high performance computers
- IoT device installation, network and security implementation and configuration
- Automation of IoT devices using IFTTT, Alexa, Voice Monkey, Siri and Google
- Wordpress design and SEO consulting
- Data recovery services
- Liaison between our clients, utility companies and third-party vendors, including Verizon, AT&T, Xfinity, Spectrum, T-Mobile, web hosts, software vendors, etc. Opening tickets with vendors, holding them accountable and following their progress until resolution
- Tutoring for basic Windows OS and other third party software programs and applications including A/V software, Office, Wordpress, financial software, CAD software, musician recording software, etc.
- Support for mobile devices including security, software and hardware issues
- Install, configure and maintain wired and wireless video surveillance cameras with cloud and local NVR solutions with redundancy support
- Troubleshooting and hardware support of wired and wireless surveillance camera systems

- Wordpress website design and editing services including SEO, domain management, DNS, security and backup
- Migration of emails to cloud based servers
- Microsoft 365 administrative and configuration
- Hyper-V projects to create multimedia servers
- Linux projects to create IoT integrations bridging Homekit and Alexa
- Microsoft Azure project - created VM to build a SEIM using Microsoft Sentinel
- Clients consist of residential, healthcare, mechanics, law firms, HVAC companies, hair salons, construction contractors, retail, electricians and engineers

#### **EOIR Technologies - 08/2015-05/2017**

##### **CECOM Software Engineering Center (SEC)**

##### **Quality Assurance Engineer / Configuration Management (security clearance)**

- Drafted, archived and tracked changes for all software development documentation while recommending process revisions to management
- Storage and review of all software documentation, software executables, source code, test results, IAVA updates, test cases, etc.
- Partnered with the developers, security and government to make sure standards were met and major/minor software releases were properly documented and submitted to the customer
- Systematic monitoring of the products, processes, and services to ensure they met requirements and complied with SEC organizational policies, standards and procedures
- Maintained integrity and traceability for software products and related documentation, support environments, software builds, software source code, testing, systems engineering, training, etc.
- Successfully created the configuration management program and quality assurance program
- Defense Intelligence Information Enterprise (DI2E) administrator
- Working knowledge and daily use of Atlassian Confluence, JIRA, Stash and GIT
- Jenkins and Zephyr experience

#### **General Dynamics - 05/2009-05/2015**

##### **U.S. Army Informations Systems Engineering Command**

##### **Lead Field Network Engineer / Quality Assurance Representative (security clearance)**

- Attended project engineering meetings to review issues and provide technical advice and guidance on issues
- Delivered expert telecommunications support and services relating to the installation of voice and data circuits, telecommunication equipment, networking equipment, terminal equipment and various other network services
- Inspected and supervised installation, testing and commissioning of fiber optic cable, voice and data networks both classified and un-classified
- Reviewed technical reports from manufacturers to ensure equipment was being installed to specs
- Maintained Quality Assurance Evaluation (QAE) and Quality Control (QC) reports, checklists, logs, safety reports and ensure the installation, repair and maintenance of the telecommunications network infrastructure standards were maintained in accordance with standards
- Reviewed as-builts, proposed drawings, spec changes, architectural design review drawings and design build drawings
- Created and maintained all of the quality assurance checklists to ensure all standards and regulations were being followed
- Led and managed a team of three engineers, providing strategic oversight and guidance to ensure project success and team development

- Subject matter expert (SME) of TIA/EIA, NFPA 70, BICSI, I3A, PDS, UFC and other field related codes

**STG - 11/2007-03/2009**

**U.S. Army Research Laboratory**

**Senior Plant Cable Technician (security clearance)**

- Responsible for support, installation and troubleshooting of the communications and network infrastructure including SONET(s), Cisco and Brigade switches, fiber optic, CAT6 and coaxial connections
- Engineered and designed telecommunications systems and equipment rooms
- Created network diagrams for outside plant and indoor fiber and copper infrastructure
- Cisco switch administration
- Managed resources and inventory for our division

**MedStar Health - 02/2004-01/2007**

**Telecommunications Analyst**

- Installation, MACs, troubleshooting and maintenance of telecommunications hardware and software (Siemens, Inter-tel, Spectralink, ROLM, AT+T, Avaya, etc.), PBX and phone mail troubleshooting and installation at multiple hospitals and business offices
- Diagnosis, installation and repair of network connections and Cisco network equipment, VOIP systems and Polycom AV equipment
- Provided technical expertise on telecommunication systems and infrastructure for various contracts and customers; meeting with customers to gather and analyze requirements; attend site surveys of a customer's location to obtain specific work details; prepare cost estimate based on customer requirements; recommend products
- Experience with traffic flows through the telecommunications network and voice messaging systems, performance characteristics and capabilities of the system components
- Resolved major network issue of the piloted PACS (radiology) network at Good Samaritan Hospital
- Installed and troubleshot specialized hospital lab networks, McKesson/Azyxxi system and Zebra label printers

**L.H. Cranston - 12/2003-05/2004**

**Service Department Electrical Mechanic**

- Installation, troubleshooting and maintenance of low voltage and high voltage electrical circuits, lighting and electrical services from supplier
- Worked in residential, commercial and industrial environments

**ElectraTech Services, Inc. - 07/1998-12/2003**

**IT Infrastructure Supervisor/Project Manager**

- Installation, MACs, troubleshooting and maintenance of telecommunications hardware and infrastructure
- Installations of voice, data and fiber optic cabling
- Worked in industrial, residential, commercial and hospital environments
- Installed network switches, network racks, networked time card machines

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## Skills & Experience

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### IT & Security

- **Security Remediation:** Addressing breaches, compromised accounts, phishing, scams, and intrusion.
- **Malware Protection & Cloud Solutions:** Implementation and management of malware protection, cloud storage and backups.
- **Network and Cyber Security:** Implementation of secure protocols, 2FA, wireless security, internet privacy and security, and social media privacy.
- **Server Administration:** Cloud-based server configuration, system administration, data migration.
- **IoT Integration & Automation:** Installation and security configuration of IoT devices, automation using IFTTT, Alexa, Siri, Google.
- **Mobile Device Support:** Implementation and troubleshooting of software and hardware issues.
- **Data Recovery:** Recovery services for lost or damaged data from SSDs and HDDs.
- **Website Management & SEO:** Wordpress design, SEO consulting, domain management, DNS, security, and backup.
- **Virtualization:** Experience with VMWare and Hyper-V virtual machines.
- **Software & OS Management:** Installation, maintenance, and upgrades of software and operating systems including Windows, Office, ConnectWise, TeamViewer, Remote Desktop, LogMeIn, AnyDesk, Acronis, Ubuntu, endpoint protection, backup solutions, etc.
- **Network Support:** Installation and support of wired/wireless networks, managed switches, firewalls.
- **Telecom System Support:** Expertise in PBX systems, VOIP, Cisco network equipment, installation and troubleshooting.
- **Diverse IT Environment Experience:** Proven expertise in residential, commercial, healthcare, and government IT systems.
- **Hardware and Software:** Expert in analyzing, troubleshooting and resolution of hardware and software failures.

### Project & Client Management

- **Project Leadership:** Leading and mentoring teams, managing IT projects to completion.
- **Vendor Liaison:** Coordinating with utility, software and hardware vendors for technical support and issue resolution.
- **Process & Flowchart Design:** Ability to create, implement, improve and follow IT processes and workflows.
- **Documentation & QA:** Creating, maintaining, and tracking technical documentation, ensuring compliance with standards.
- **Technical Communication:** Strong written and verbal communication skills, effectively conveying complex technical concepts with clarity, detail, and professionalism to non-technical clients and C-suite.
- **Time Management and Organization:** Highly organized with the ability to re-prioritize and adapt to dynamic changes in projects and incidents.
- **Customer Retention:** Proven track record of customer retention through a great personality and holding myself and others to the highest of standards.

### Additional Skills

- **Continuous Learning:** Proactively expanding expertise through ongoing skill development.

- **High-Pressure Problem Solving:** Proven ability to maintain efficiency and effectiveness in high-stress and emergency situations.
- **Root Cause Analysis & Problem-Solving:** Methodically diagnose issues and implement effective, long-term solutions which often involving reverse engineering techniques
- **Technical Drawing & Interpretation:** Skilled in interpreting, revising, and designing telecommunications and general construction drawings.  
**Communication:** Expert in demonstrating and translating complex technical concepts into clear, accessible language for non-technical audiences.
- **Work Ethic & Integrity:** Known for honesty, dependability, and a strong commitment to delivering exceptional results.
- **Customer Satisfaction:** Achieved the highest customer survey scores at MedStar Health, demonstrating dedication to client needs and service excellence.
- **Performance Recognition:** Awarded Top-Rated Employee at STG and GDIT for outstanding contributions and work ethic.
- **Analytical Thinking:** Successfully led projects requiring critical thinking and innovative solutions, showcasing a strong analytical mindset.
- **Adaptability & Continuous Learning:** Quick learner with the ability to grasp new information rapidly and adapt to evolving technologies and environments.
- **Strategic Mindset:** Excel in fast-paced settings by approaching challenges with a methodical, solution-oriented perspective.
- **Sales:** Multiple industry sales experience with a love for building strong, genuine relationships and understanding client needs with the retention of previous customers.

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### Education/Awards

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| 1992 -1996 | Calvert Hall College High School Towson, MD                                 |
| 1996 -1998 | Essex Community College Essex, MD                                           |
| 2002       | Siecor CAT5 Training White Marsh, MD                                        |
| 2002       | Siecor Fiber Optic Training White Marsh, MD                                 |
| 2006       | Hilti Firestop Certification White Marsh, MD                                |
| 2006       | BICSI Information Transport Systems Installer 1 Certification Baltimore, MD |
| 2007       | Corning Cable Systems LANscape Solutions LinkUp Program Baltimore, MD       |
| 2008       | STG "Outstanding Job Award"                                                 |
| 2008       | Fluke Networks education                                                    |
| 2009       | Confined Spaces Training APG, MD                                            |
| 2009       | Safety Construction Class APG, MD                                           |
| 2011       | USACE Project Delivery Award                                                |
| 2011       | DoD Information Assurance Awareness APG, MD                                 |
| 2012       | OSHA Confined Spaces Training APG, MD                                       |